

Post-incident review PIR-2025-013

Customer Portal: partial outage

Contoso Platform Engineering. Fictional sample data.

Summary

On 02 March 2025, Customer Portal experienced partial outage in production (AU East) for about 55 minutes. A scripted sign-in probe started failing from two regions. Investigation found that a feature flag was switched on for every tenant instead of the pilot group.

Impact

Users of Customer Portal saw partial outage for about 55 minutes. The service owner, Digital Channels, led the response.

Timeline

- 09:06 First signal received.
- 09:39 Incident declared and on-call team engaged.
- 09:55 Likely cause identified.
- 10:26 Mitigation applied.
- 10:53 Service confirmed healthy and incident closed.

What happened

Investigation found that a feature flag was switched on for every tenant instead of the pilot group.

No dependency outages were reported by upstream providers during the window.

The relevant alert had fired repeatedly the previous week and had been muted by the on-call engineer.

What went well

Responders communicated clearly in the incident channel and the status page was updated within fifteen minutes of the incident being declared.

Actions

- Assign a named owner for the component in the service catalogue.
- Add a circuit breaker and timeout on the upstream call.
- Write and rehearse a runbook for this failure mode.